

Journal selection report

Original research · pragmatic clinical trial · 4,900 words · three recommended journals

This is a redacted sample. It shows the structure and level of detail of a real deliverable. Client names, journal names and identifying particulars have been removed or changed. Ask us and we will send one built around a manuscript like yours.

The shortlist

Three journals, ranked, with one named as the primary target. Percentages are the fit score against the brief agreed with you before the search: scope 28%, study design 20%, audience reach 14%, impact 14%, decision speed 12%, publication charge 12%.

Rank	Journal	Fit and reasoning
1 · submit here first	Journal A (named in your copy)	94% — publishes pragmatic trials of this design. CONSORT expectations and statistical reporting match your analysis plan. The composite endpoint you used appears in three papers it ran last year.
2	Journal B	88% — broader scope and a faster median decision at 31 days. Accepts the composite endpoint without supplementary justification. Lower impact, wider clinical readership.
3	Journal C	81% — fully open access with an institutional waiver route your university qualifies for. Lowest impact of the three, highest reach into the audience this work addresses.

Metrics, verified at the date of this report

Journal	JIF	CiteScore	SJR	Accept.	1st decision	To publish	Indexed in
Journal A	16.2	27.7	6.008	11.1%	42 days	5.1 months	SCIE · Scopus · PubMed
Journal B	8.4	14.2	2.417	19.6%	31 days	3.8 months	SCIE · Scopus · PubMed
Journal C	3.9	7.1	1.032	31.2%	24 days	2.9 months	ESCI · Scopus · DOAJ

Figures are taken from the journals' own current reporting and from Clarivate, Scopus and DOAJ at the date of the report. They are not quoted from a stored list.

What was ruled out, and why

The exclusion log is the part most authors find useful. It is the evidence that the shortlist was reasoned rather than picked.

Journal	Reason excluded
Journal D	Scope. Publishes mechanistic work in this area but has not run a clinical trial in four years.
Journal E	Article type. Does not accept pragmatic trials; the instructions restrict to explanatory designs.
Journal F	Charge. APC of \$4,100 exceeds the \$2,500 ceiling you set as a hard filter.
Journal G	Indexing. Not in Scopus, which you set as a hard requirement.
Journal H	Integrity. Publisher meets several of the WAME predatory-practice indicators. Not recommended at any price, and the reasons are set out in the full report.

Free reselection. If the paper is rejected as out of scope by any journal on this list, or if a recommended title is later acquired by a publisher we would not recommend, we produce a fresh shortlist at no charge.

Submission notes

- Journal A requires the CONSORT checklist as a separate upload with page numbers completed.
- All three require trial registration before first participant enrolment — your registration predates it.
- Journal B counts references inside the 3,500-word limit. Journals A and C do not.
- Journal C requires figures as separate TIFF files at 300 dpi rather than embedded.
- Journal A operates double-blind review; the anonymised manuscript is a separate file.

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